

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-26

Change Request Form and Change Log

The instrument for raising a change and the register of all changes

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Change Request Form and Change Log
Document reference	<i>PMB-26-HEL-T2-v1.0</i>
Project / Programme	<i>Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build</i>
Version	<i>1.0</i>
Status	<i>Baselined</i>
Date	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>
Author	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Owner	<i>Project manager</i>
Approver	<i>Per the authority levels in the change management plan</i>
Classification	<i>Internal</i>
Retention	<i>7 years from programme closure</i>

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-25	Change Management Plan	Defines the process and authorities
PMB-27	Issue Log	Issues often generate change requests
PMB-08	Requirements Documentation and Traceability Matrix	Requirements changes traced here

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Provides the standard form for requesting a change to a baseline, including impact assessment and decision record, together with the log of all change requests and their status.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Integration Management — Perform Integrated Change Control
Created when	Per change request; log maintained continuously
Reviewed / updated	At every change control board and progress review
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Per the authority levels in the change management plan
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Keep the form short enough that people use it. A change process people avoid produces undocumented change, which is worse than no process.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- The requester states the business reason, not just the change
- Impact assessment addresses every dimension, including "no impact" where true
- Options are offered, including the do-nothing option
- Decisions record rationale, not just the outcome
- The log is complete — rejected and withdrawn requests are retained

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1. Change request form — request

Field	Detail
Change request ref	PMB-26-HEL-T2-v1.0
Date raised	18 Sep 2026
Raised by	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect
Title	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Type	Scope / Schedule / Cost / Quality / Requirement / Corrective / Preventive / Defect repair
Priority	Emergency / High / Medium / Low
Description of change	Integration partner claim for additional structural works
Business reason	Physical lead times do not tolerate emerging requirements, so this element is frozen before order
Consequence of not making the change	Reduce Tranche 2 GPU count from 2,048 to 1,792
Related issue / risk ref	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance

2. Impact assessment

Dimension	Impact	Quantified	Assessed by	Date
Scope	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational	18 Sep 2026

Dimension	Impact	Quantified	Assessed by	Date
		<i>readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.</i>	<i>readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.</i>	
Schedule	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	18 Sep 2026
Cost	<i>AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation</i>	<i>AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation</i>	<i>AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation</i>	18 Sep 2026
Quality	<i>No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full</i>	<i>No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full</i>	<i>No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full</i>	18 Sep 2026
Risk	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	18 Sep 2026
Benefits	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	<i>No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation</i>	18 Sep 2026
Resources	<i>Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval</i>	<i>Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval</i>	<i>Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval</i>	18 Sep 2026
Security and compliance	<i>Reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing</i>	<i>Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance</i>	<i>J. Ferreira, Network Lead</i>	18 Sep 2026

Dimension	Impact	Quantified	Assessed by	Date
Other projects / operations	WS5 MLOps and developer experience	WS2 Compute and storage hardware	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	18 Sep 2026

3. Options

Option	Description	Cost	Schedule impact	Risk	Recommendation
Do nothing	Continue with four departmental GPU estates and growing public cloud rental	AED 19.4m per year and rising ~40% annually	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Cost growth is unbounded and four residency exceptions remain open	Baseline only. Rejected — fails the residency obligation.
Option A	Add a second CDU to hall A to reach the 60 kW design point	AED 1,120,000	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Three-week schedule impact on hall A acceptance	Recommended.
Option B	Accept a reduced 48 kW density and cap hall A at 1,536 GPUs	No additional cost	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Capacity shortfall of 512 GPUs carried into Tranche 3	Not recommended — breaks the Tranche 2 capacity commitment.

4. Decision

Field	Detail
Decision	Approved / Approved with conditions / Rejected / Deferred / Withdrawn
Option selected	No
Rationale	Physical infrastructure has long lead times and low requirement volatility; the platform layer has short feedback loops and genuinely emergent requirements

Field	Detail
Conditions	<i>Performance bond of 10%, step-in rights, and design documentation held in escrow</i>
Authority level applied	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Decided by	<i>F. Mansour, Business Change Lead</i>
Date	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>

5. Implementation and closure

Field	Detail
Implementation owner	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Target completion	<i>30 Jul 2027</i>
Baselines updated	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>
Documents updated	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>
Stakeholders notified	<i>Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026</i>
Verified by	<i>R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO</i>
Closed date	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>

6. Change log

Ref	Date	Title	Type	Raised by	Priority	Cost impact	Schedule impact	Authority	Decision	Decided	Status
CR-001	14 Jul 2026	<i>Add coolant leak detection integration to the NOC</i>	<i>Scope</i>	<i>G. Lindqvist,</i>	<i>High</i>	<i>AED 240,000</i>	<i>No impact</i>	<i>Project manager</i>	<i>Approved</i>	<i>S. Bhatt, Project</i>	<i>Implemented</i>

Ref	Date	Title	Type	Raised by	Priority	Cost impact	Schedule impact	Authority	Decision	Decided	Status
				Service Operations Lead						Manager	
CR-002	02 Aug 2026	Dual-source 20% of Tranche 2 accelerator volume	Scope	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	High	AED 1,840,000	+2 weeks	Programme Board	Approved	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	In progress
CR-003	25 Aug 2026	Bridge the hall B row 3 service void rather than relocate racks	Scope	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	Medium	AED 96,000	No impact	Project manager	Approved	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	Implemented
CR-004	18 Aug 2026	Integration partner claim for additional structural works	Cost	Nexora Integration Services	Medium	AED 1,840,000	No impact	Programme Board	Deferred	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Under review
CR-005	05 Sep 2026	Defer confidential computing enabler from Tranche 2 to Tranche 3	Scope	T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Medium	-AED 2,800,000	No impact	Programme Board	Approved	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Implemented
CR-006	11 Sep 2026	Extend contractor SRE cover by six months	Cost	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	High	AED 720,000	No impact	Programme Board	Approved	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Implemented
CR-007	09 Sep 2026	Add a second CDU to hall A to reach the 60 kW design point	Cost	A. Kowalski, Data Centre	High	AED 1,120,000	+3 weeks	Programme Board	Under review	—	Open

Ref	Date	Title	Type	Raised by	Priority	Cost impact	Schedule impact	Authority	Decision	Decided	Status
				Lead							
CR-008	01 Sep 2026	Reduce Tranche 2 GPU count from 2,048 to 1,792	Scope	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Low	-AED 11,400,000	No impact	Programme Board	Rejected	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Closed

7. Change summary

Measure	This period	Cumulative
Requests raised	18 Sep 2026	AED 4,060,000
Approved	Q4 2026	AED 24,940,000
Rejected	Oct 2026	AED 986,000
Outstanding	1	AED 4,060,000
Net cost impact	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 1,798,000
Net schedule impact	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	AED 1,798,000